CHAPTER 16

Running Tests Faster and Running Faster Tests

Over the course of the book, I've talked about how important rapid feedback is to getting the full benefit of the TDD process. You can make your TDD feedback happen faster in several ways. You can run a focused subset of your test suite so that you see only the tests relating to the code you're working on. You can have tests run automatically when code changes. You can make the loading of the Rails application happen in the background or you can bypass Rails altogether. And, of course, you can just avoid doing really slow things.

Let's look at the many ways to speed up tests.

Running Smaller Groups of Tests

Running just some of your tests at once is often useful. If you have a slow test suite, running a relevant subset of tests will let you get most of the value of rapid testing feedback without the cost of the entire test suite. When debugging, you often just care about one or two tests. Also, if you're being verbose about printing output to the terminal, then only running one test will spare you from potentially having to wade through a lot of spurious output. If you're running Pry, being able to only run one test will let you focus better.

Prescription 43	If you have a slow test suite, you can mitigate the effects in practice by being able to run a relevant subset of tests.

Each tool has its own way to allow you to run one file or one set of tests at once. Also, your editor or IDE probably has a built-in feature or common